

Surfing the Digital Wave with ADDC



The application driven data centre (ADDC) is a design whereby all the components of the data centre can communicate directly with an application layer. As a result, applications can directly control the data centre components for better performance and availability in a cost-optimised way. ADDC redefines the roles and skillsets that are needed to manage the IT infrastructure in this digital age.

Worldwide, the IT industry is undergoing a tectonic shift. To the Indian IT service providers, this shift offers both new opportunities and challenges.

For long, the Indian IT industry has enjoyed the privilege of being a supplier of an English-speaking, intelligent workforce that meets the global demand for IT professionals. Till now, India could leverage the people cost arbitrage between the developed and developing countries. The basic premise was that IT management will always require skilled professional people. Therefore, the operating model of the Indian IT industry has so far been headcount based.

Today, that fundamental premise has given way to automation and artificial intelligence (AI). This has resulted in more demand for automation solutions and a reduction in headcount—challenging the traditional operating model. The new solutions in demand require different skillsets. The Indian IT workforce is now struggling to meet this new skillset criteria.

Earlier, the industry's dependence on people also meant time-consuming manual labour and delays caused by manual errors. The new solutions instead offer the benefits of automation, such as speeding up IT operations by replacing people. This is similar to the time when computers started replacing mathematicians.

But just as computers replaced mathematicians yet created new jobs in the IT sector, this new wave of automation is also creating jobs for a new generation with new skillsets.

In today's world, infrastructure management and process management professionals are being replaced by developers writing code for automation.

These new coding languages manage infrastructure in a radically different way. Traditionally, infrastructure was managed by the operations teams and developers never got involved. But now, the new management principles talk about managing infrastructure through automation code. This changes the role of sysadmins and developers.

The developers need to understand infrastructure operations and use these languages to control the data centre. Therefore, they can now potentially start getting into the infrastructure management space. This is a threat to the existing infrastructure operations workforce, unless they themselves skill up as infrastructure developers.

So does it mean that by learning to code, one can secure jobs in this turbulent job market? The answer is both 'Yes' and 'No'. 'Yes', because in the coming days everyone needs to be a developer. And it's also a 'No' because in order to get into the infrastructure management space, one needs to master new infrastructure coding languages even if one is an expert developer in other languages.

New trends in IT infrastructure

The new age infrastructure is built to be managed by code. Developers can benefit from this new architecture by controlling infrastructure from the applications layer. In this